

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

“Booth Babes”

Ever wonder how many women there are at gaming conferences? There are quite a few, and

What's more interesting is that there's actually a site for them—e3girls.com! Naturally, it's image-heavy.



Look—they're even wearing “booth babe” T-shirts!

they don't play the games: they're referred to as the “booth babes.” Essentially, they're under-dressed women who entice the geeks to come and play their game.

Last year, the babe thing at E3—the world's largest annual video game conference, held in Los Angeles—went over the top, it's reported. Girls were ambling about in bikinis. The industry decided to tone it down this year, ostensibly to make the game industry seem a bit more family-friendly. But then, sex games are taking off, and what can we expect at next year's E3?

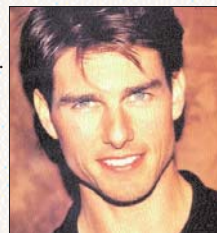
Looking at the site, you get the feeling that men *really* love the booth babes. There's a picture archive of the women at E3 booths for all the years that the conference happened. You get the feeling that they're as much of an attraction as the games!

From the site: “The best collection of E3 booth babes!! Upload and share your E3 babe pictures... we all know: you didn't only play the games!” Then, “Do you have e3 girl photos, if you attended the conferences you probably do.”

So how does this reflect on the role of Woman in society?

That's My Name!

Tom Cruise doesn't own TomCruise.com. The owner happens to be the world's most famous cybersquatter, Jeff Burgar. Cruise has taken Burgar to a domain name arbitrator so as to get “his” domain back.



While the legal proceedings are on, fans can head to the sad-sounding tomcruise.com. Actually, the legalities are fascinating: since this site already has a fan site up, do they have a

right to TomCruise.com? Anyway, here's a word of advice: register your name dot com today to avoid having to confront the Burgars of the world—just in case you become a celebrity some day. It's a bit late in the day, though, for Rajeshes and Deepaks, but the Tathagathas and the Chittaswarups of the world have it easy.

Burgar knows at least some of the loopholes. He's won against Kevin Spacey for exactly the same kind of thing, and also against Bruce Springsteen. He lost against Pierce Brosnan, Celine Dion, and Michael Crichton. It sounds a little like a game...

He Bluffed His Way Through

A London cabbie has probably been reading *Digit*—each month, we tell folks how to bluff their way through various things tech, and this man did exactly that!

The cabbie was mistaken for IT expert Guy Kewney, in the following fashion: he was holding a badge for Kewney at the BBC studio reception. A producer called out for “Guy Kewney,” and the cabbie was ushered on to a studio set.

Now, instead of doing the square thing by telling people he was not actually Kewney, he decided to field the planned interview, which was about a

court battle between Apple iTunes and Apple Corps!

Even as the real Mr Kewney watched the interview in disbelief, the cabbie answered several questions, possibly including a few gems and some generic answers—as in “I'm very surprised to see this verdict... because I was not expecting that.”

His interviewer did catch on after some such answers, but it goes to show that bluffing one's way through IT isn't all that difficult! Get some news tidbits from here and there, develop a know-it-all attitude, and rattle off buzzwords!

Pretty Please...

Red Hot Chili Peppers released their new album *Stadium Arcadium* on 9 May. Naturally, it was on P2P networks, and fans were downloading it. Not good for RHCP. So they resorted to begging, pleading, and emotional blackmail (“Please don't download the album! Give us your money instead!”). It really did involve emotion: Flea, the bassist, told fans in a letter posted on the Web site of the Red

Hot Chili Peppers Fan Club that it would “break his heart” if they downloaded the new album!

Fans should, Flea said, appeal to their consciences before deciding whether to download the album or buy it. There's no news on how many folks appealed to their consciences before double-clicking the album icon in their P2P clients. It's sad, really.

Or is it a sham to boost album sales just a little bit?

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